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Loosening Philosophy's Tongue: a Conversation with Jack Caputo

John D. Caputo; Carl A. Raschke

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More than any contemporary American philosopher, John D. ('Jack') Caputo has been instrumental in making both the name Jacques Derrida and the slippery term 'deconstruction' household words. His three biennial conferences on 'postmodernism' at Villanova University in Pennsylvania since the mid-1990s have not only drawn leading international figures, including Derrida, but also provided an opportunity for countless scholars to comprehend the players and issues connected to the movement itself. In this lively conversation with JCRT senior editor Carl A. Raschke, Caputo talks about his own project and style, particularly his effort to show us how Derrida is not only an illustrious philosopher, but a religious thinker as well. In that regard Caputo charts a trajectory for postmodernist thought that has only been dimly thought to the present. And he distinguishes his reading of Derrida decisively from that of Mark C. Taylor, whom JCRT interviewed in this spot a year ago.

John D. Caputo is the David R. Cook Professor of Philosophy at Villanova University, where he has taught since 1968. His most recent publications include *On Religion* (Routledge, 2001), *The Prayers and Tears of Jacques Derrida* (Indiana, 1997) and *Deconstruction in a Nutshell* (Fordham, 1997). He is presently at work on a book on deconstruction and the "kingdom of God."

Carl A. Raschke is professor of religious studies at the University of Denver and senior editor of the Journal for Religious and Cultural Theory. His major books include *The End of Theology* (The Davies Group, 2000), *Fire and Roses: Postmodernity and the Thought of the Body* (SUNY 1996), *The Engendering God* (Westminster Press, 1995), *Painted Black* (Harper Collins, 1990), *Theological Thinking* (Scholars Press, 1988). He is the author of over 200 popular and scholarly articles on subjects ranging from postmodern religious thought to computer-mediated education to new religious movements. He is formerly president of the Rocky Mountain-Great Plains Region of the American Academy of Religion and an editor of several series with the American Academy of Religion. He is also a well-known national media personality.

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